

PlayIQ Curriculum

Module 1

Node 1: What AI Is Good At vs Bad At

Big Idea:

- AI is powerful, but it is not magic.
- It can help you learn faster. It can also confuse you if you use it badly.

AI is good at:

- explaining ideas in different ways
- giving examples
- helping break down a hard topic
- quizzing you
- helping you organize your thoughts

AI is bad at:

- always being correct
- fully understanding your teacher's exact expectations
- knowing when something is missing
- replacing your judgment

Read this carefully

- AI often sounds confident. That is important. Something can sound polished, clear, and smart... and still be wrong.
- So one of the most important rules in this program is: Confident is not the same as correct.

Why this matters for you

- If you use AI well, it can help you: understand faster, get unstuck faster, learn in a way that fits your brain.
- If you use AI badly, it can: do the thinking for you, make you trust weak answers, make you feel smart without actually learning.
- The goal in PlayIQ is not to look smart. The goal is to become smarter.

Activity: Good Use, Risky Use, or Bad Use?

Instructions:

- Read each example and decide whether it is: Good Use, Risky Use, or Bad Use.
- Then answer the 2 reflection questions in full sentences.

Scenarios:

- "Explain photosynthesis like I'm 12."
- "Write my entire essay for me."
- "Give me 5 practice questions about fractions."
- "Tell me the exact answer to my worksheet."
- "Help me understand what I got wrong."
- "Summarize this paragraph, then quiz me on it."
- "Solve all my homework and I'll copy it."
- "Give me a simpler example of this equation."

Reflection:

- One way AI can help me learn better is..
- One way AI could make me weaker if I used it badly is..

Mini Check

- Why can AI be useful for learning?
- Why is AI sometimes risky to trust?
- What is one sign that an AI answer should be checked?

Teach Back

Explain to a younger student why AI can be useful but still needs to be checked.

Node 2: Choosing the Right AI Mode

Big Idea:

- Different problems need different kinds of help.
- If you use the wrong mode, learning gets slower, messier, and more frustrating. If you use the right mode, learning gets faster and clearer.
- In PlayIQ, your AI is not just answering you. It is also learning how to teach you better.
- That means the way you respond, the kinds of prompts you use, and the modes you choose all help shape your AI into a better coach for your brain.

The 6 Modes

- 1. Explain Mode: Use this when learning something new, wanting a simpler explanation, or wanting something taught in your specific style.
- 2. Hint Mode: Use this when you already started a problem, want a clue (not the answer), and want to keep your brain doing the work.
- 3. Quiz Mode: Use this when testing memory or checking if you really understand before a test.

- 4. Coach Mode: Use this when you need a plan, feel overwhelmed, or want structure to your studying time.
- 5. Learn Your Way Mode: Use this when explanations are not clicking and you want the AI to learn how your brain works.
- 6. Lesson Rescue Mode: Use this when a whole paragraph/note is confusing and you need help finding exactly where you got lost.

Activity: Pick the Best Mode

Instructions:

- Now that you know the six modes, you're going to practice using them.
- Choose the best mode for each situation below. Make sure to specify the exact mode.

Scenarios:

- You want to understand a confusing paragraph from biology.
- You already tried a math problem and want a clue.
- You want to test whether you remember yesterday's lesson.
- You need a study plan for an exam next week.
- You pasted your notes and want help finding the confusing part.
- You want the explanation changed to fit how you learn best.

Mini Check

- When should you use Hint Mode instead of Explain Mode?
- When is Lesson Rescue Mode better than Coach Mode?
- Why does choosing the right mode matter?

Teach Back

Teach someone when they should use Hint Mode instead of Explain Mode.

Node 3: Ask Better Questions

Big Idea:

- The quality of your learning depends on the quality of your questions.
- Weak questions lead to weak learning. Better questions lead to better learning.
- When you ask better questions, your AI gets better at helping you. It learns your gaps, your thinking, and how to teach you faster.

Weak question vs strong question

- Weak question: "What's the answer?" (That pushes AI to think for you)
- Better questions: "Can you explain this simply?" "Give me a hint instead of the answer." "What do students usually misunderstand here?"

The Question Ladder

- Step 1: What is this?
- Step 2: Why does it work this way?
- Step 3: Can you explain it more simply?
- Step 4: Can you show me an example?
- Step 5: Can you test me on it?
- Step 6: Can you ask me questions that will help me learn this faster?

Activity: Upgrade These Weak Prompts

Instructions:

- Rewrite each weak prompt underneath it so it helps you learn instead of shortcutting.
- After that, write 3 strong prompts for something you're currently learning in school.

Scenarios:

- "What's the answer?"
- "Do this for me."
- "Write my paragraph."
- "Solve this worksheet."
- "Tell me what to put."

Mini Check

- Why are better questions important?
- What is the difference between a shortcut prompt and a coaching prompt?
- What kind of prompt would you use if you wanted a simpler explanation and then a test?

Teach Back

Why do better questions lead to better learning?

Node 4: Verify Before You Believe

Big Idea:

- Verifying is not extra work. Verifying is learning.
- If you check whether something is true, compare it, question it, and make sure it makes sense, you are building real understanding.
- AI can sound smarter than it actually is, and produce answers that sound polished but are not truly correct.

- The permanent PlayIQ rule: Verify before you believe.

The PlayIQ Verification Ritual

- 1. Does this make sense? (Do I understand it, or does it just sound smart?)
- 2. Can I explain it myself? (If I cannot explain it, I probably do not own it yet.)
- 3. Can I cross-check it? (Can I compare it with class notes or a trusted source?)
- 4. Is anything missing or suspicious? (Does it feel too confident, vague, or incomplete?)

AI voice vs your voice

- AI often writes in a polished, robotic, generic style.
- If you use AI to understand something, then write it using your own brain, your answer sounds natural, human, and like you actually own the material.

Activity: Spot the Problem

Instructions:

- Read each answer and decide: Looks good, Needs checking, or Wrong.
- Then provide a full sentence explaining why.

Scenarios:

- "Photosynthesis is how plants make food using sunlight."
- "The Civil War ended in 1992."
- "A metaphor compares two things without using 'like' or 'as.'"
- "Fractions are always smaller than whole numbers."
- "The Earth has one moon."

Reflection:

- Take one real school concept and run the verification ritual on it. Write 2-4 sentences showing how you checked it.

Mini Check

- Why is verifying part of learning?
- What are the 4 steps of the PlayIQ Verification Ritual?
- Why can copying AI language make your work weaker instead of stronger?
- What is the difference between using AI to learn faster and using AI to cheat yourself?

Teach Back

What does "verify before you believe" mean in school?

Module 2

Node 1: The Power Tool Principle

Big Idea:

- Technology is a multiplier.
- That means it makes things bigger. If you are focused, it can make you more effective. If you are distracted, it can make you more distracted. If you are curious, it can help you learn faster. If you are lazy, it can help you avoid effort and become weaker.
- AI is not automatically good or bad. It becomes powerful depending on how you use it.

Think of AI like a power tool

- A power tool can help you build something faster.
- But if you use it carelessly, it can damage the thing you are trying to build.
- In this case, the thing you are building is your mind.

The better question

- The question is not just: "Can AI help me?"
- The better question is: "What is AI helping me become?"

Why this matters

- AI and the internet give you access to more knowledge, more tools, and more leverage than almost any generation before you.
- But it also means you have more responsibility.
- If you use these tools carelessly, they can work against you. If you use them consciously, they can become a real superpower.

Activity: Superpower or Superweapon?

Instructions:

- For each example below, decide whether AI is being used like a Superpower or a Superweapon Against You.
- Write your answer and then explain your thinking in one sentence.
- Format: "Superpower — because..." or "Superweapon Against You — because..."

Scenarios:

- "I use AI to explain difficult science ideas in simpler words."
- "I use AI to scroll through random image prompts for an hour instead of studying."
- "I use AI to quiz me before a test."
- "I use AI to write my full answer so I don't have to think."

- "I use AI to help me plan my homework."
- "I use AI to avoid effort every time school feels hard."

Reflection:

- One way technology can become a superpower for me is:
- One way technology could become a superweapon against me is:

Mini Check

- What does it mean that technology is a multiplier?
- Why is AI not automatically good or bad?
- What is one sign that a tool is helping you become weaker instead of stronger?

Teach Back

Explain the Power Tool Principle to a younger student. Why does it matter how you use AI, not just whether you use it?

Node 2: Truth, Trust, and Misinformation

Big Idea:

- Not everything that sounds smart is true.
- And not everything you see online deserves your trust.
- One of the most important skills in the modern world is learning how to tell the difference between what is true, what is misleading, what is incomplete, and what only sounds believable.
- Bad information spreads fast. And if you believe things too quickly, you stop thinking clearly.

Why this matters

- A lot of false information sounds polished.
- It may use big words, sound confident, look professional, or be repeated by a lot of people.
- But repetition is not proof. Confidence is not proof. A polished answer is not proof.
- Real thinkers do not just absorb information — they examine it.

The Truth Filter

- 1. Is this actually true? Or does it just sound smart?
- 2. Where is this coming from? Is it based on something real, or just generated language?
- 3. Can I compare it with another trusted source? Do my notes, textbook, or teacher materials agree?
- 4. Is anything missing? Could this be partly true, but incomplete?

Activity: Spot the Problem

Instructions:

- For each statement below, choose: Reliable, Needs Checking, or Likely False.
- Write your answer and explain: "Reliable — because..." or "Needs Checking — because..."

Scenarios:

- "Plants use sunlight to help make food."
- "The moon gives off its own light."
- "A paragraph is usually built around one main idea."
- "All metals are magnetic."
- "The internet always gives the fastest way to the truth."

Reflection:

- Why do you think people believe false or weak information so easily sometimes? Write 2–4 sentences.

Mini Check

- Why is confidence not the same as truth?
- What are the 4 parts of the Truth Filter?
- Why is comparing information with another source important?

Teach Back

Teach someone the Truth Filter. Explain each of the 4 questions and why they matter.

Node 3: Attention, Distraction, and Algorithm Traps

Big Idea:

- Your attention is valuable.
- A lot of apps, platforms, and content are designed to keep you watching, clicking, scrolling, and reacting.
- That means if you do not protect your attention, someone else will use it for their own goals.
- This is one of the biggest digital skills you can learn: knowing the difference between using technology on purpose and getting used by it.

Rest vs Escape

- Rest: You intentionally relax, reset, and recharge.
- Escape: You avoid what matters by disappearing into distraction.

- The internet can do both. The question is not "Am I online?" — the better question is "Am I using this on purpose?"

The Attention Check

- Why did I open this?
- Is this helping me or pulling me away?
- Am I creating, learning, or just consuming?
- Will I feel stronger or weaker after this?
- If you ask these questions often, you become much harder to distract.

Activity: Trap Audit

Instructions:

- Write down 3 attention traps that pull you off track
- Use this format for each trap:
- Trap [#]: [name] | Why it gets me: [reason] | One boundary I can use: [boundary]
- Example — Trap 1: Short videos | Why it gets me: They are easy to keep watching without thinking | One boundary I can use: Set a timer before opening the app

Scenarios:

- Trap 1: [describe an attention trap that distracts you]
- Trap 2: [describe a second attention trap]
- Trap 3: [describe a third attention trap]

Mini Check

- What is the difference between rest and escape?
- Why is your attention valuable?
- What is one attention boundary you want to start using?

Teach Back

Explain the difference between rest and escape, and describe one attention trap from your own life.

Node 4: Human Responsibility and the Highest Path

Big Idea:

- You are responsible for what you do with power.
- That includes your time, your attention, your words, your tools, and your choices.
- AI and the internet can help you become stronger, smarter, and more capable.
- But they can also help you become more distracted, less disciplined, and more dependent.
- That is why we use the Highest Path Test.

The Highest Path Test

- 1. Does this make me stronger or weaker?
- 2. Does this build my future or steal from it?
- 3. Is this true, or do I just want it to be true?
- 4. Would I be proud if someone I respect saw this choice?
- 5. Am I using this to create... or to escape?

Why this matters

- A lot of bad choices feel easy in the moment.
- That's why people copy things they didn't learn, believe things they didn't check, waste time they meant to use well, and let technology train their habits instead of choosing them.
- The highest path is not always the easiest choice. But it is the one that makes you stronger over time.

Activity: Highest Path Scenarios

Instructions:

- For each situation below, decide which choice is the highest path.
- Write: Which option is the highest path and why.
- Example — Situation: You have an essay due tomorrow. A: Ask AI to write the whole thing. B: Ask AI to help you organize your ideas and then write it yourself. → B is the highest path because it helps me learn and still do the work myself.

Scenarios:

- You are confused about a history topic. A: Copy an AI answer and move on. B: Ask AI to explain it simply, then quiz you.
- You are tired and don't want to study. A: Scroll videos for an hour. B: Do one 10-minute mission first, then decide what to do next.
- You want to impress your teacher. A: Turn in polished AI writing you don't understand. B: Learn the idea well, then write it in your own words.
- You find a confident online claim. A: Believe it because it sounds smart. B: Check whether it is true first.

Reflection:

- Which of the 5 Highest Path Test questions would help you most right now? Explain why in 2–3 sentences.

Mini Check

- What is the Highest Path Test?
- Why is the highest path not always the easiest path?
- Which Highest Path question do you think would help you most right now, and why?

Teach Back

Explain the Highest Path Test. Choose 2 of the 5 questions and explain what they mean in your own words.

Node 5: Integrity and Identity

Big Idea:

- Every time you use AI, you are building a habit.
- And habits shape identity.
- That means every time you choose effort over shortcut, learning over copying, truth over convenience, or growth over escape — you are becoming a stronger kind of person.
- But every time you choose shortcuts that replace your thinking, you are training the opposite identity.

Cheating is an identity problem

- Cheating is not just a rule problem. It is an identity problem.
- If AI does the work and you pretend it is yours: your confidence becomes fake, your skill stays weak, your future depends on hiding what you can't actually do.
- That is a dangerous way to live.
- Real confidence comes from earned skill.

The PlayIQ principle

- "AI can coach me, but I earn the skill."
- This is why PlayIQ is built around this idea.
- Using AI to understand is coaching. Using AI to replace your thinking is cheating yourself.

Activity: Coach or Cheat?

Instructions:

- For each example below, decide whether it is: Coach, Cheat, or Borderline / Needs Caution.
- Write your answer and explain: "Coach — because..." or "Cheat — because..."

Scenarios:

- "I ask AI to write my paragraph and I turn it in."
- "I ask AI to give me a hint and then I finish the problem."
- "I ask AI to make me practice questions."
- "I copy an AI answer because I don't want to think."
- "I ask AI to help me organize my notes before I study."

Reflection:

- I want to become the kind of student who...
- One shortcut I want to stop using is...
- One stronger habit I want to build is...

Mini Check

- Why is cheating an identity problem, not just a school problem?
- What does "AI can coach me, but I earn the skill" mean?
- What kind of student do you want to become?

Teach Back

Explain why cheating yourself is different from just breaking a rule. What does it do to your identity over time?

Node 6: Social Impact: Privacy, Respect, and Digital Power

Big Idea:

- What you do online affects other people.
- Technology is not just about what helps you. It is also about what kind of impact you create.
- That means part of being smart with technology is learning to use it with respect, caution, responsibility, and self-control.

Why this matters

- Today, it is easy to share something too quickly, pass along misinformation, use someone else's image or words badly, invade privacy, or hurt people without fully thinking about the consequences.
- Being digitally smart means slowing down enough to ask "Is this helpful, true, respectful, and responsible?"

The Pause Before Share Rule

- 1. Is it true?
- 2. Is it respectful?
- 3. Do I have the right to use or share it?
- 4. Could this hurt someone if I'm wrong?

Activity: Pause Before Share

Instructions:

- For each situation below, decide the smartest action.

- Write: Best action and Why.
- Example — Situation: You see a shocking fact in a comment section. Best action: Don't share it yet. Why: I should check if it's true first.

Scenarios:

- A friend sends you a fake-looking image and says, "Post this, it's hilarious."
- You find an AI-generated paragraph online and want to use it in your work.
- You read an exciting fact that matches what you already believe.
- You want to repost something but you are not sure it is true.

Reflection:

- Why does digital power come with responsibility? Write 2–3 sentences in your own words.

Mini Check

- Why does digital power come with responsibility?
- What is the Pause Before Share Rule?
- Why should privacy and respect matter online?

Teach Back

Explain the Pause Before Share Rule to someone who has never heard of it. Why does it matter?

Module 3

Node 1: Topic Mapping

Big Idea:

- Do not ask AI to explain everything at once.
- That usually creates too much information.
- First, ask AI to make a simple map.
- A learning map shows the main parts of a topic so your brain knows where to start.

Prompt to Use

- "Act as my PlayIQ learning coach. Help me pre-learn [topic] for school. Break it into 5 simple parts. Keep it clear and not overwhelming. Do not do my homework for me. After the map, ask me one question to check what I already understand."

Activity: Pre-Learn Map

- Fill in: Topic / Part 1 / Part 2 / Part 3 / Part 4 / Part 5
- The part I understand most is:
- The part that looks most confusing is:
- One question I have is:

Activity: Pre-Learn Map

Instructions:

- Choose one real school topic you are about to study.
- Use AI with the prompt above to generate a 5-part map.
- Fill in the activity fields below based on what AI gives you.

Scenarios:

- Topic I am pre-learning:
- Part 1 of the map:
- Part 2 of the map:
- Part 3 of the map:
- Part 4 of the map:
- Part 5 of the map:

Reflection:

- The part I understand most is:
- The part that looks most confusing is:
- One question I have is:

Mini Check

- Why is a topic map better than asking AI to explain everything at once?
- Which part of your map seems easiest?
- Which part should you study first?

Teach Back

Explain why mapping a topic before diving in makes learning faster. Use an example from your own school subject.

Node 2: First Principles

Big Idea:

- A first principle is the main truth underneath a topic.

- It answers: What is this really about?
- If you understand the core idea, details become easier.

Prompt to Use

- "Explain the core idea of [topic] in three levels: 1. simple version, 2. normal school version, 3. slightly deeper version. Then ask me which version helped me most."

The 10-Line Summary Template

- 1. This topic is about...
- 2. The main idea is...
- 3. One key word is..
- 4. Another key word is...
- 5. A simple example is...
- 6. This example matters because...
- 7. One common mistake is..
- 8. I should remember...
- 9. I still need to check...
- 10. My best question for class is...

Activity: Core Idea Card

Instructions:

- Use the prompt above with AI to get three levels of explanation for your topic.
- Rate each level (1-5) and write your own one-sentence explanation.

Scenarios:

- Topic:
- Simple version (and my rating 1-5):
- Normal school version (and my rating 1-5):
- Deeper version (and my rating 1-5):
- The version that helped me most was:
- My own one-sentence explanation:

Reflection:

- Write your 10-Line Summary (all 10 lines in your own words):

Mini Check

- What is the core idea of your topic?
- Which explanation level helped you most?
- What question would you ask your teacher or AI next?

Teach Back

Explain the core idea of your chosen topic to someone who has never heard of it. Use the simplest level that is still accurate.

Node 3: Example-First Learning

Big Idea:

- Examples help your brain see how the idea works.
- A strong pattern is: example first, pattern second, rule third, practice fourth.
- A non-example is also useful because it shows what the idea is not.

Prompt to Use

- "Give me 2 simple examples of [topic], 1 non-example, and explain why each one matters. Keep the examples school-appropriate and easy to understand. After that, ask me to explain the difference between the example and non-example."

Example from the PDF

- Topic: Metaphor
- Example 1: "The classroom was a zoo." — compares classroom to a zoo without using like or as.
- Example 2: "His voice was thunder." — directly compares voice to thunder.
- Non-example: "His voice was like thunder." — uses like, so it is a simile, not a metaphor.
- Pattern: A metaphor compares two things directly.

Activity: Example Stack

Instructions:

- Use AI with the prompt above for your chosen topic.
- Record the 2 examples, 1 non-example, and the pattern you noticed.

Scenarios:

- Topic:

- Example 1 and why it fits:
- Example 2 and why it fits:
- Non-example and why it does NOT fit:
- The pattern I notice is:

Reflection:

- Which example helped most and why?
- What did the non-example make clearer?

Mini Check

- Which example helped most?
- What did the non-example make clearer?
- What pattern did you notice?

Teach Back

Teach someone what a non-example is and why using one helps you understand the real idea faster.

Node 4: Self-Test Loop

Big Idea:

- You do not know something just because it sounds familiar.
- You know it when you can answer questions, fix mistakes, explain it in your own words, and use it without copying.
- That is why every pre-learn session ends with a self-test.

Prompt to Use

- "Quiz me on [topic] one question at a time. Start easy, then make it a little harder. Do not give me the answer until I try. If I get one wrong, explain the mistake simply and ask a follow-up question."

Learning Supercharger Note

- When your future AI tutor helps with this topic, it should remember:
 - Explanation style that helped most
 - The part that was most confusing
 - The mistake you made
 - Best practice style
 - One thing to quiz you on next

Activity: 5 Self-Test Questions

Instructions:

- Use the prompt above with AI. Record all 5 questions AI asked you.
- Write your answer and whether you got it correct.
- Track your score and what you learned from any mistakes.

Scenarios:

- Question 1 + my answer + correct or not yet:
- Question 2 + my answer + correct or not yet:
- Question 3 + my answer + correct or not yet:
- Question 4 + my answer + correct or not yet:
- Question 5 + my answer + correct or not yet:

Reflection:

- Score: ___ / 5. One mistake I made was:
- The fix was:
- One thing I understand better now is:

Mini Check

- Why should AI wait until you try before giving answers?
- What did your self-test reveal?
- What should your future Learning Supercharger remember about how you learn?

Teach Back

Explain why a self-test is more powerful than rereading. What does testing prove that rereading does not?

Module 4

Node 1: Paste, Chunk, Scan

Big Idea:

- Confusing material feels harder when it is all smashed together.

- Chunking makes it easier to handle.

Prompt to Use

- "Act as my PlayIQ Lesson Rescue coach. I am going to paste a confusing school section. Do not do my work for me. Break it into 3 to 6 simple chunks. Give each chunk a short label. Then ask me to rate my understanding of each chunk from 1 to 5."

Activity: Chunk Scan Table

Instructions:

- Choose one confusing school section (paragraph, slide, notes section).
- Use AI with the prompt to chunk it.
- Rate your understanding for each chunk.

Scenarios:

- Subject & Topic:
- Chunk A label and score (1-5):
- Chunk B label and score (1-5):
- Chunk C label and score (1-5):

Reflection:

- The chunk I understand best is:
- The chunk I understand least is:
- One word or phrase that feels confusing is:

Mini Check

- Why is chunking better than asking AI to explain everything at once?
- Which chunk was hardest?
- What did your understanding score help you notice?

Teach Back

Explain how breaking a large confusing text into smaller chunks helps your brain process it better.

Node 2: Identify Gap Type

Big Idea:

- Not all confusion is the same.
- If you know the type of confusion, you can fix it faster.
- Gap types: Word Gap, Background Gap, Step Gap, Connection Gap, Overload Gap, Expectation Gap.

Prompt to Use

- "Based on my chunk ratings, ask me 3 short questions to figure out my main gap type. Do not give me the full explanation yet. Help me identify whether this is a word gap, background gap, step gap, connection gap, overload gap, or expectation gap."

Activity: Gap Diagnosis Card

Instructions:

- Use AI to diagnose the type of gap for your hardest chunk.
- Record the gap type and what showed you that.

Scenarios:

- Hardest chunk:
- My main gap type is:
- I know this because:
- One clue that showed the gap was:

Reflection:

- The best next move is:

Mini Check

- What was your main gap type?
- How did you figure it out?
- Why is it useful to know the type of confusion?

Teach Back

Explain the difference between a Word Gap and an Overload Gap to someone else.

Node 3: Remediate in Personal Style

Big Idea:

- Once you find the gap, do not reteach everything.
- Teach only the missing piece.
- That is faster and less overwhelming.

Choose a Repair Style

- Pick one: simple explanation, step-by-step explanation, example-first explanation, analogy, quick diagram-style explanation, quiz me through it.

Prompt to Use

- "Teach only the missing piece from this chunk [chunk]. My gap type is: [gap type]. Use this style: [repair style]. Keep it short. Give me one example. Then ask me one check question before moving on."

Activity: Repair Card

Instructions:

- Choose a repair style and use AI to fix the specific gap.
- Record the missing piece and answer the check question.

Scenarios:

- Chunk I repaired & Gap type:
- Repair style I chose:
- The missing piece was:
- The example that helped me was:
- The check question AI asked me was:

Reflection:

- My answer was:
- Did I get it right? (yes or not yet)

Mini Check

- What repair style helped most?
- What was the missing piece?
- What sentence makes more sense now?

Teach Back

Explain why you should only repair the missing piece instead of reteaching the whole chapter.

Node 4: Adaptive Questioning Loop

Big Idea:

- You do not prove understanding by nodding.
- You prove it by answering questions.

Prompt to Use

- "Ask me 4 questions about this rescued chunk, one at a time. Start easy, then make them slightly harder. Do not give me the answer before I try. If I get one wrong, diagnose why I missed it and give me a smaller hint."

Activity: Rescue Loop Tracker

Instructions:

- Answer 4 questions from AI about your rescued chunk.
- Track your results and what you learned from any mistakes.

Scenarios:

- Question 1 result (correct or not yet) and what I learned:
- Question 2 result (correct or not yet) and what I learned:
- Question 3 result (correct or not yet) and what I learned:
- Question 4 result (correct or not yet) and what I learned:

Reflection:

- Score: ___ / 4
- One mistake I made and the fix was:
- One thing I understand better now is:

Mini Check

- Why should AI ask one question at a time?
- What did your mistake show you?
- How did the loop improve your understanding?

Teach Back

Explain why proving understanding through questions is better than just saying "I get it now."

Node 5: Teach-Back Unlock

Big Idea:

- You do not own the idea until you can explain it in your own words.

- A teach-back proves: I understand this now.

Prompt to Use

- "I am going to explain this rescued chunk in my own words. After I explain it, score my teach-back from 1 to 5 using this checklist: clear main idea, correct key terms, good example, not copied from AI, no major confusion left. Then give me one improvement suggestion."

Activity: Teach-Back Record

Instructions:

- Write 5 to 7 sentences explaining the rescued chunk.
- Get feedback from AI and record your improved sentence.

Scenarios:

- This lesson section is about... The most important idea is...
- One key word is... An example is...
- The part that confused me before was... Now I understand that...

Reflection:

- AI Teach-back score: ___ / 5
- One thing I did well and one thing I need to improve:
- My final improved sentence:

Mini Check

- Why is teach-back required before mastery?
- What changed from the start to now?
- What should your future Learning Supercharger remember?

Teach Back

Teach someone the process of rescuing a confusing lesson step-by-step from chunking to teach-back.

Module 5

Node 1: The 3-Ways Rule

Big Idea:

- A strong learner can explain one idea in more than one way.
- The 3-Ways Rule means you can ask for: 1. an analogy, 2. step-by-step, 3. example-first.

Prompt to Use

- "Act as my PlayIQ learning coach. Teach [topic] in three ways: analogy, step-by-step, and example-first. Keep each one short. After each version, ask me to rate how helpful it was from 1 to 5."

Activity: 3-Ways Scorecard

Instructions:

- Choose a topic that still feels hard.
- Use AI to teach it 3 ways and rate each one.

Scenarios:

- Topic:
- Analogy version rating (1-5) & what helped/did not help:
- Step-by-step version rating (1-5) & what helped/did not help:
- Example-first version rating (1-5) & what helped/did not help:

Reflection:

- The strongest explanation style for me was:
- Why:

Mini Check

- Which explanation style helped most?
- Which style helped least?
- What does this tell your future Learning Supercharger?

Teach Back

Explain a single concept in two different ways (e.g., as an analogy and as a step-by-step process).

Node 2: Safe Simplification

Big Idea:

- A simple explanation is useful only if it stays accurate.
- Bad compression makes the idea sound easy but wrong.
- Good compression makes the idea clear and still true.

Prompt to Use

- "Simplify [topic] for me, but do not make it inaccurate. Give me one too-simple version, one better simple version, and one warning about what students often oversimplify."

Activity: Safe Simplification Check

Instructions:

- Use AI to see the difference between a bad simplification and a good one.

Scenarios:

- Too-simple version:
- Why it is risky or incomplete:
- Better simple version:
- Why it is clearer:

Reflection:

- Warning about oversimplifying:
- My final accurate simple explanation:

Mini Check

- What is the danger of oversimplifying?
- What did your too-simple version leave out?
- What is your best accurate simple explanation?

Teach Back

Explain the difference between simplifying something so it is clear, versus oversimplifying it so it becomes wrong.

Node 3: Build a 1-Page Understanding Card

Big Idea:

- A 1-Page Understanding Card is a small study asset that captures the most useful version of a topic.
- It is not a giant note sheet. It is a clear page you can review fast.

Prompt to Use

- "Help me build a 1-Page Understanding Card for [topic]. Ask me for my own answer in each section before improving it. Do not write the whole card for me without my input."

Activity: 1-Page Card Elements

Instructions:

- Build your card by providing the core idea, simple explanation, analogy, and common mistakes.

Scenarios:

- Subject & Topic:
- Core idea & Best simple explanation:
- Best analogy or example:
- Key words (list 3):

Reflection:

- Common mistake and how to avoid it:
- One sentence teach-back:

Mini Check

- What belongs on a 1-Page Understanding Card?
- What should not be included?
- How could this help before a quiz?

Teach Back

Explain how having a 1-Page Understanding Card is better than having five pages of copied notes.

Node 4: Practice Without Spoon-Feeding

Big Idea:

- Practice is where understanding becomes skill.
- But practice only works if AI does not give away the answer too fast.

Prompt to Use

- "Give me 5 practice questions on [topic], one at a time. Do not give the answer until I try. If I get stuck, give a hint instead of solving. After each answer, tell me what I did well and what to fix."

Activity: Practice Tracker

Instructions:

- Answer the 5 questions AI provides and track your results.

Scenarios:

- Question 1 & 2 results:
- Question 3 & 4 results:
- Question 5 result:
- Score: ___ / 5

Reflection:

- Most common mistake:
- Best hint AI gave me:
- What I need to review next:

Mini Check

- Why should AI not solve too fast?
- What was your most common mistake?
- What kind of hint helped most?

Teach Back

Explain why it is important to force AI to give hints instead of giving you the final answer when practicing.

Module 6**Node 1: Why Rereading Fails****Big Idea:**

- Rereading can help a little, but it often tricks you.
- You recognize the answer when you see it, but you may not be able to produce it yourself.
- Retrieval practice means pulling the answer from your brain. That is stronger.

Prompt to Use

- "Explain why rereading can feel helpful but still fail. Then help me create a quick retrieval practice test for [topic]. Do not give answers until I try."

Activity: Rereading vs Retrieval**Instructions:**

- Think about something you recently studied by just reading over it.

Scenarios:

- Write one thing you reread recently:
- Did it feel familiar? (yes or no)
- Could you explain it without looking? (yes or no)

Reflection:

- What does that show you about rereading versus retrieving?

Mini Check

- Why can rereading trick students?
- What is retrieval practice?
- Why is retrieval stronger than recognition?

Teach Back

Explain to a friend why reading a textbook chapter three times is less effective than taking a blank piece of paper and trying to write out what you remember.

Node 2: Retrieval Practice System**Big Idea:**

- A good self-test is not random.
- It should include: easy recall, meaning, examples, application, and mistake correction.

Prompt to Use

- "Create a 6-question retrieval practice test for [topic]. Include 2 easy recall questions, 2 understanding questions, 1 example question, and 1 application question. Ask me one question at a time. Do not reveal answers until I try."

Activity: Retrieval Tracker**Instructions:**

- Take the 6-question test and track your results.

Scenarios:

- Question 1 & 2 results:
- Question 3 & 4 results:
- Question 5 & 6 results:
- Score: ___ / 6

Reflection:

- Strongest question type:
- Weakest question type:
- What I need to practice next:

Mini Check

- Which question type was easiest?
- Which question type was hardest?
- What does that tell you?

Teach Back

Explain the difference between an easy recall question and an application question.

Node 3: Mistake Bank Patterns**Big Idea:**

- A mistake is data.
- The goal is not to feel bad. The goal is to find the pattern.
- Mistake Types: Knowledge Gap, Word Gap, Step Error, Careless Error, Transfer Error, Confidence Error.

Prompt to Use

- "Help me sort my missed questions into mistake types: knowledge gap, word gap, step error, careless error, transfer error, or confidence error. Ask me why I missed each one before giving your opinion."

Activity: Mistake Bank Snapshot**Instructions:**

- Log up to 3 mistakes you made recently into your Mistake Bank

Scenarios:

- Mistake 1 - Question & My answer:
- Mistake 1 - Mistake type & Why I missed it:
- Mistake 2 - Question & My answer:
- Mistake 2 - Mistake type & Why I missed it:

Reflection:

- What pattern do you notice in your mistakes?
- How can you fix this pattern next time?

Mini Check

- What is a Knowledge Gap vs. a Careless Error?
- Why is it important to know the type of mistake?
- How does a Mistake Bank help you study better?

Teach Back

Teach someone else how classifying mistakes (like "Step Error" or "Word Gap") makes studying less frustrating and more effective.

Node 4: Progressive Correction**Big Idea:**

- Mistakes should be corrected progressively, not just reviewed once.
- You must prove you can answer the missed question correctly after time has passed.

Prompt to Use

- "I want to review the mistakes from my Mistake Bank. Give me questions similar to the ones I missed, but change the examples or numbers so I cannot just memorize the answer. Ask them one at a time."

Activity: Correction Loop**Instructions:**

- Have AI generate new questions based on your previous mistakes.

Scenarios:

- Original Mistake 1 Type & New Question AI gave:
- Did I get it right this time? (yes or no)

- Original Mistake 2 Type & New Question AI gave:
- Did I get it right this time? (yes or no)

Reflection:

- What feels easier now compared to the first time you tested yourself?

Mini Check

- Why should AI change the examples when re-testing you?
- Did you improve on your second attempt?
- Why is reviewing mistakes a few days later important?

Teach Back

Explain the concept of Progressive Correction. Why is it not enough to just look at the right answer and move on?

Module 7

Node 1: 10-Line Summary System

Big Idea:

- A good summary is short, clear, and useful.
- A bad summary copies too much.
- The 10-Line Summary forces you to decide what matters.

Prompt to Use

- "Act as my PlayIQ study coach. Help me turn my notes on [topic] into a 10-Line Summary. Ask me to write my first version before improving it. Do not write the whole summary without my attempt."

Activity: 10-Line Summary

Instructions:

- Turn your notes into a 10-Line Summary following the template.

Scenarios:

- 1. This topic is about...
- 2. The main idea is...
- 3. Key term 1 & 4. Key term 2 & 5. Key term 3:
- 6. One example is..
- 7. One common mistake is..
- 8. One thing I should remember is..
- 9. One thing I need to check is..
- 10. My best study question is..

Reflection:

- Which line was hardest to write?
- What does that show you?

Mini Check

- Why is a 10-Line Summary better than copying notes?
- Which line was hardest to write?
- What does that show you?

Teach Back

Explain why copying a full page of notes is less effective for learning than forcing yourself to write a 10-Line Summary.

Node 2: Turn Notes Into Questions

Big Idea:

- Notes are not finished until they can test you.
- Every useful note should turn into a question.
- This changes studying from passive reading into active recall.

Prompt to Use

- "Help me turn these notes into study questions. Make 3 easy questions, 3 medium questions, and 2 challenge questions. Do not include answers until I try."

Activity: Notes to Questions

Instructions:

- Convert your notes into 3 Easy, 3 Medium, and 2 Challenge questions.

Scenarios:

- Easy questions 1, 2, 3:
- Medium questions 1, 2, 3:
- Challenge questions 1, 2:

Reflection:

- Question I missed or struggled with:
- What that tells me:

Mini Check

- Why should notes become questions?
- Which question type was hardest?
- What should you practice next?

Teach Back

Explain how turning your notes into questions changes how your brain interacts with the material.

Node 3: Find Missing Links

Big Idea:

- A missing link is the part between two ideas that you do not understand yet.
- You may know the words, but not the connection.
- Finding missing links makes studying faster.

Prompt to Use

- "Look at my summary and questions. Ask me 3 diagnostic questions to find any missing links. Tell me whether the missing link is a word, step, connection, example, or background idea."

Activity: Missing Link Finder

Instructions:

- Identify missing links in your understanding of the notes.

Scenarios:

- My missing link is:
- Type (word, step, connection, example, or background):
- Clue that showed this:
- Best repair move:

Reflection:

- One better question to ask

Mini Check

- What missing link did you find?
- What type was it?
- How will you repair it?

Teach Back

Explain the difference between knowing the definitions of words and understanding the "missing link" connections between them.

Node 4: Precision Prompting

Big Idea:

- A vague prompt gives vague help.
- A precision prompt tells AI: role, task, topic, limits, format, effort rule, output.
- This is the beginning of custom instruction thinking.

Precision Prompt Formula

- Role: Act as my learning coach.
- Task: Help me study this topic.
- Topic: [topic]
- Limits: Keep it short and do not give answers before I try.
- Format: Ask one question at a time.
- Effort rule: I must attempt before you explain.
- Output: End with a short review plan.

Prompt to Use

- "Act as my PlayIQ learning coach. Help me improve this prompt using the precision prompt formula. Keep it beginner-friendly and explain what you changed."

Activity: Prompt Upgrade

Instructions:

- Take a weak prompt and upgrade it to a precision prompt.

Scenarios:

- Weak prompt:
- Upgraded precision prompt:
- What changed:
- Why it is stronger:

Reflection:

- How it keeps AI as coach, not crutch:

Mini Check

- What makes a prompt precise?
- Why do limits matter?
- How is this connected to custom instructions?

Teach Back

Explain to a friend why adding "Limits" and an "Effort Rule" to an AI prompt makes the AI a much better tutor.

Module 8**Node 1: Claim, Evidence, Reasoning****Big Idea:**

- Strong school answers often need three parts: Claim, Evidence, and Reasoning (CER).
- Claim: What you think or answer.
- Evidence: What supports it.
- Reasoning: Why the evidence proves the claim.

Prompt to Use

- "Act as my writing coach. Help me identify the claim, evidence, and reasoning in my answer. Do not rewrite it for me. Ask me questions if a part is missing."

Activity: Answer Blueprint**Instructions:**

- Take a rough school answer and use AI to break it down into CER.

Scenarios:

- Question or prompt:
- My claim & My evidence:
- My reasoning & Missing part:

Reflection:

- Question AI asked me:
- My improved idea:

Mini Check

- What is a claim?
- What is evidence?
- What is reasoning?

Teach Back

Explain how using Claim, Evidence, Reasoning (CER) makes your writing stronger than just giving an opinion.

Node 2: Outline First**Big Idea:**

- Outlining prevents messy writing.
- A short outline can save a lot of time.
- The outline should guide your answer, not replace your thinking.

Prompt to Use

- "Help me make a simple outline for my answer. Ask me for my claim first. Then ask me what evidence I want to use. Do not write the final paragraph."

Activity: Outline Builder**Instructions:**

- Work with AI to build a simple outline for your answer.

Scenarios:

- Claim:
- Evidence 1 & Evidence 2:
- Reasoning & Closing thought:

Reflection:

- What I still need to check

Mini Check

- Why outline before drafting?
- What part of your outline is strongest?
- What part needs more work?

Teach Back

Explain to a friend why spending 5 minutes on an outline saves 30 minutes of getting stuck while writing.

Node 3: Feedback Prompt System

Big Idea:

- Good AI feedback is specific. Bad feedback just says "Make this better."
- Good feedback asks for clarity, logic, structure, missing evidence, confusing sentences, and teacher expectations.

Prompt to Use

- "Act as my writing coach. Review my answer for clarity, logic, structure, and missing evidence. Do not rewrite it. Give me 3 specific suggestions and ask me which one I want to fix first."

Activity: Feedback Tracker

Instructions:

- Paste your draft and use the feedback prompt to get 3 suggestions.

Scenarios:

- My answer:
- AI suggestion 1, 2, 3:
- Suggestion I chose first:

Reflection:

- My revision & Why I changed it:

Mini Check

- Why is specific feedback better?
- Which suggestion helped most?
- How did you stay the writer?

Teach Back

Teach someone how to ask AI for specific feedback on their writing instead of asking AI to "fix it."

Node 4: Revision Loop

Big Idea:

- Revision means improving your own work. It does not mean letting AI replace your voice.
- A strong revision keeps your meaning but makes it clearer.

Prompt to Use

- "I will revise my own answer. After I revise, compare my first version and revised version. Tell me what improved, what still needs work, and whether it still sounds like me."

Activity: Before and After Revision Sample

Instructions:

- Revise your answer using the feedback, then have AI check your revision.

Scenarios:

- Original answer & Feedback I used:
- Revised answer:
- What improved & What still needs work:

Reflection:

- One sentence I am proud of:

Mini Check

- What changed between your first and revised version?

- Does it still sound like you?
- What writing habit do you want to keep?

Teach Back

Explain the difference between revising your own work with AI coaching, versus letting AI ghostwrite the answer for you.

Module 9

Node 1: What Makes a Good AI Tutor

Big Idea:

- A good AI tutor does not just answer.
- A good tutor asks questions, gives hints, explains in your style, checks understanding, catches confusion, refuses shortcuts, helps you prove mastery, and helps you become independent.

Bad Tutor vs Good Tutor

- Bad tutor: Gives full answers immediately. Good tutor: Asks what you tried, gives a hint, then checks understanding.
- Bad tutor: Writes your homework. Good tutor: Helps you understand the assignment and plan your own answer.

Activity: Tutor Quality Check

Instructions:

- Define 3 things your tutor should do and 3 things it should NOT do.

Scenarios:

- 3 things my tutor should do:
- 3 things my tutor should not do:

Reflection:

- Why should your tutor avoid giving full answers too fast?

Mini Check

- Why should your tutor avoid full answers too fast?
- What is one behavior your tutor must have?
- What is one behavior your tutor must block?

Teach Back

Explain to a parent the difference between using AI as an "Answer Machine" versus using it as a "Learning Coach."

Node 2: Tutor Personality vs Tutor Function

Big Idea:

- Personality is how your tutor feels. Function is what your tutor does.
- You need both, but function matters more.
- Example Function: explain, hint, quiz, rescue confusion, track mistakes, verify understanding.

Prompt to Use

- "Help me choose a tutor personality and tutor functions. Ask me 5 questions. Then summarize my choices in a simple tutor profile."

Activity: Tutor Profile

Instructions:

- Use AI to determine the best personality and functions for your tutor.

Scenarios:

- Tutor name & Tutor personality:
- Feedback style & Pacing:
- Top 5 functions:
- My tutor should avoid:

Reflection:

- Which matters more for learning, personality or function?

Mini Check

- What is the difference between personality and function?
- Which matters more for learning?
- What personality will help you stay focused?

Teach Back

Explain why a funny tutor that gives away answers is worse than a boring tutor that forces you to think.

Node 3: Beginner Custom Instructions

Big Idea:

- Custom instructions tell your AI tutor how to behave.
- They should be clear, practical, and **safe**. They do not need to be fancy.
- They need to tell the tutor: who it helps, what it does, how it teaches, what it must not do, and how to protect integrity.

Prompt to Use

- "Help me turn my tutor profile into beginner custom instructions. Keep them clear and not too advanced. Make sure the tutor acts as a coach, not a crutch."

Activity: My Tutor Instruction Sheet

Instructions:

- Complete the custom instructions template using your AI coach.

Scenarios:

- Tutor Role & Student Profile:
- Teaching Rules (3-5 rules):
- Integrity Rules (What it must not do):
- Verification Rules & Response Format:

Reflection:

- Why do integrity rules belong inside your custom instructions?

Mini Check

- What are custom instructions?
- Why do integrity rules belong inside them?
- What is one rule your tutor must follow?

Teach Back

Explain what custom instructions are to someone who has never heard of them.

Node 4: Choosing What Your Tutor Should Know

Big Idea:

- Knowledge files give your tutor useful context.
- But messy files create messy help. Good knowledge files are organized.
- Good Knowledge File Types: learning profile, study goals, Mistake Bank notes, 1-Page Understanding Cards, Study Packs.

Bad Knowledge File Types

- - random screenshots with no labels
- - copied answers
- - unfinished homework for AI to complete
- - private information you should not share
- - giant messy document dumps

Activity: Knowledge File Sorting

Instructions:

- Identify which files you will include and which you will keep out.

Scenarios:

- List 5 files or artifacts you should include:
- List 3 things you should NOT include:

Reflection:

- What file would help your tutor most?

Mini Check

- What makes a good knowledge file?
- Why are messy files a problem?
- What file would help your tutor most?

Teach Back

Explain why giving AI your exact "Mistake Bank" is better than just telling AI "I am bad at math."

Node 5: Using Knowledge Files to Improve Teaching

Big Idea:

- A knowledge file should make your tutor more useful.
- It should help your tutor understand what you are learning, where you get stuck, and what mistakes to watch for.

Tutor Knowledge File Pack

- File 1: Learning Profile. File 2: Study Goals. File 3: Mistake Patterns. File 4: Study Artifacts. File 5: Tutor Rules.

Activity: Build Your Tutor Knowledge Pack

Instructions:

- Choose at least 3 starter files for your tutor and define their purpose.

Scenarios:

- File 1 name & Purpose:
- File 2 name & Purpose:
- File 3 name & Purpose:

Reflection:

- How will these files improve your tutor?

Mini Check

- Which knowledge file matters most?
- How will it improve your tutor?
- What information should stay out?

Teach Back

Explain how providing a "Mistake Patterns" file changes the way the tutor will quiz you in the future.

Node 6: Tutor Testing and Refinement

Big Idea:

- You do not know if your tutor works until you test it.
- A first version is not final. You test, notice problems, revise, and test again.

Test Scenarios

- 1. I do not understand this topic.
- 2. I tried this problem and need a hint.
- 3. Quiz me on this.
- 4. I want you to write my homework. (Shortcut request)
- 5. Help me verify this answer.

Activity: Tutor Test and Revision Log

Instructions:

- Run your tutor through at least 3 test scenarios (including one shortcut request).

Scenarios:

- Test 1 Scenario & Tutor response:
- Test 2 Scenario & Tutor response:
- Test 3 Scenario & Tutor response:

Reflection:

- What worked well and what needed improvement?
- Final tutor improvement or instruction revision made:

Mini Check

- Why test with shortcut requests?
- What did your tutor do well?
- What instruction needs revision?

Teach Back

Teach someone why building an AI tutor is an ongoing process of testing and refining, not just a one-time setup.

Module 10

Node 1: What Makes a Good AI Assistant

Big Idea:

- A good assistant has a clear job.
- A weak assistant tries to do everything.
- The clearer the purpose, the more useful the assistant.

Assistant Purpose Formula

- This assistant helps [user] do [task] by [support method], while avoiding [boundary].
- Example: This assistant helps my parent plan weekly meals by organizing preferences, grocery ideas, and simple recipes, while avoiding medical or diet advice.

Activity: Assistant Purpose Draft**Instructions:**

- Draft a purpose sentence for two assistants: one for yourself, one for someone else.

Scenarios:

- My assistant for myself - User & Task:
- Support method & Boundary:
- Purpose sentence:
- My assistant for someone else - User & Task:
- Support method & Boundary:
- Purpose sentence:

Reflection:

- Why should an assistant have one clear purpose?

Mini Check

- Why should an assistant have one clear purpose?
- What makes an assistant too broad?
- What is one assistant boundary you need?

Teach Back

Explain why an assistant that "helps with everything" is actually less useful than an assistant that "helps organize my weekend study schedule."

Node 2: Assistant Purpose and Boundaries**Big Idea:**

- Boundaries protect the user. Boundaries tell the assistant what not to do.
- This matters more when building for someone else.
- Boundary Types: Privacy, Permission, Decision, Safety, Accuracy.

Prompt to Use

- "Help me create safe boundaries for an assistant that helps with [task]. Ask me who the assistant is for, what information it needs, what it must not do, and what should be verified by a human."

Activity: Boundary Card**Instructions:**

- Define the safe boundaries for your assistant.

Scenarios:

- Assistant purpose:
- Privacy boundary & Permission boundary:
- Decision boundary & Safety boundary:
- Accuracy boundary:

Reflection:

- What the assistant should say when asked to cross a boundary:

Mini Check

- Why do assistants need boundaries?
- Which boundary matters most for your assistant?
- What should your assistant refuse?

Teach Back

Teach someone the difference between a Permission Boundary and a Decision Boundary.

Node 3: Custom Instructions for Real Tasks**Big Idea:**

- Assistant custom instructions should be task-specific.
- They tell the assistant: who it helps, what problem it solves, what information it uses, format, tone, boundaries, when to ask questions, and when to verify.

Assistant Instructions Template

- Assistant Role: You are a helpful assistant for [user] that helps with [task].
- Goal: Help get [outcome].
- User Context: User prefers [style] and wants help with [specific need].
- What To Do: Ask clarifying questions, organize clearly, give options.
- What Not To Do: Do not make major decisions, do not request private info.
- Output Format: Use [checklist/table/etc].
- Verification Rule: Remind the user to verify important info.

Activity: Assistant Custom Instructions

Instructions:

- Write the custom instructions for your assistant.

Scenarios:

- Assistant name & Assistant role:
- Goal & User context:
- What to do & What not to do:
- Output format & Verification rule:

Reflection:

- Why should instructions include what NOT to do?

Mini Check

- What are assistant custom instructions?
- Why should instructions include what not to do?
- What output format fits your assistant?

Teach Back

Explain how writing custom instructions for a task makes an AI much better than just using generic ChatGPT.

Node 4: Knowledge Files for Useful Support

Big Idea:

- Knowledge files make assistants more useful.
- But they must be safe, organized, and relevant.
- Good Files: approved preferences, checklists, templates. Bad Files: passwords, medical records, secret data.

Bad Assistant Knowledge Files

- - private passwords
- - financial account information
- - medical records
- - secrets from another person
- - private messages without permission
- - giant messy files

Activity: Knowledge File Plan

Instructions:

- Plan the knowledge files your assistant will use, making sure they are safe.

Scenarios:

- Knowledge file 1 (Name, What it includes, Why it helps):
- Permission confirmed? (yes/no):
- Knowledge file 2 (Name, What it includes, Why it helps):
- Permission confirmed? (yes/no):

Reflection:

- What file would make your assistant most useful?

Mini Check

- What makes a safe knowledge file?
- What should never go into a knowledge file?
- What file would make your assistant most useful?

Teach Back

Explain why you need explicit permission before uploading a schedule or set of preferences into an AI assistant.

Node 5: Build an Assistant for Yourself

Big Idea:

- Start with a simple assistant for yourself. Do not overbuild. Pick one real problem.
- Examples: study schedule assistant, habit tracker, weekly planning.

Activity: Personal Assistant Build Sheet

- Build and test the assistant for yourself.

Activity: Personal Assistant Build Sheet**Instructions:**

- Fill out the details of your personal assistant and test it.

Scenarios:

- Assistant name & Problem it solves:
- Custom instructions summary:
- Test scenario 1 & Test scenario 2:

Reflection:

- What worked and what needs improvement:

Mini Check

- What problem does your assistant solve?
- What did your test show?
- What should you revise?

Teach Back

Share the biggest problem you found when you first tested your assistant, and how you fixed it.

Node 6: Build an Assistant for Someone Else**Big Idea:**

- Building for someone else requires empathy. You cannot just guess. You need to ask what they need.

Mini User Interview

- Ask your chosen person:
 1. What task would you like help with?
 2. What makes that task annoying?
 3. What kind of help would be useful?
 4. What should the assistant avoid?
 5. What info are you comfortable sharing?

Activity: Real-User Assistant Build Sheet**Instructions:**

- Interview someone, build an assistant for them, and revise it based on their feedback.

Scenarios:

- Chosen user & Task they want help with:
- Main frustration & Useful support needed:
- Boundaries & Approved information:
- Test scenario & User feedback:

Reflection:

- Revision made:

Mini Check

- What did your chosen person actually need?
- What assumption did you avoid?
- How did user feedback improve the assistant?

Teach Back

Explain why you must interview the person you are building an assistant for, instead of just guessing what they want.

Node 7: Ethics, Privacy, and Boundaries**Big Idea:**

- Building assistants gives you power. Power requires responsibility.
- Your assistant should be: useful, respectful, permission-based, clear about limits, safe, and easy to correct.

Assistant Builder Responsibility Check

- 1. Did the user agree to the purpose?
- 2. Did the user approve the information?
- 3. Are private details protected?
- 4. Are boundaries clear?
- 5. Does the assistant ask the human to verify?
- 6. Can the assistant be improved?

Activity: Final Responsibility Check

Instructions:

- Run the final ethics checklist for your assistant.

Scenarios:

- Purpose approved? (yes/no):
- Private information removed? (yes/no):
- Boundaries and Verification reminders included? (yes/no):
- Feedback collected and Revision made? (yes/no):

Reflection:

- What boundary makes your assistant safer?

Mini Check

- Why is permission important?
- Why should private information be protected?
- What boundary makes your assistant safer?

Teach Back

Explain what makes an AI Builder "responsible." What rules do they follow that normal users might ignore?
